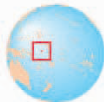


# Tuvalu



One of the world's smallest, most isolated states, Tuvalu lies in the central Pacific. The nine islands were linked to the Gilbert Islands (Kiribati) as a UK colony until independence.



## GEOGRAPHY

A series of coral atolls, none more than 15 ft (4.6 m) above sea level. Poor soils restrict vegetation to bush, coconut palms, and breadfruit trees.



## CLIMATE

Hot all year round. Heavy annual rainfall. Hurricane season brings many violent storms.



## PEOPLE & SOCIETY

People are mostly Polynesian. Around half the population lives on Funafuti, where government jobs are based. Life is communal and traditional. Most people live by subsistence farming, digging pits out of the coral to grow crops. Fresh water is precious, due to frequent droughts.

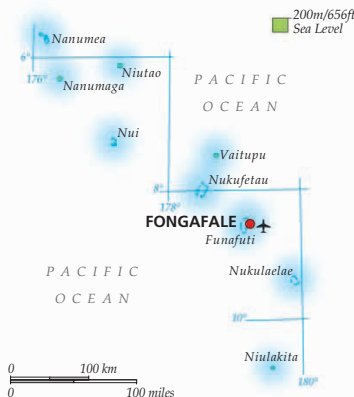


**INSIGHT:** Low-lying Tuvalu, like the Maldives, is set to disappear with rising sea levels



## THE ECONOMY

World's smallest economy. Remittances from Tuvaluan seafarers. Sale of fishing licenses. Copra, stamps, and coins exported. Income from trust fund and the lease of .tv Internet suffix.



## FACTFILE

**OFFICIAL NAME:** Tuvalu

**DATE OF FORMATION:** 1978

**CAPITAL:** Fongafale, on Funafuti Atoll

**POPULATION:** 11,100

**TOTAL AREA:** 10 sq. miles

(26 sq. km)

**DENSITY:** 1110 people per sq. mile

**LANGUAGES:** Tuvaluan, Kiribati, English\*

**RELIGIONS:** Church of Tuvalu 97%, Baha'i 1%, Seventh-day Adventist 1%, other 1%

**ETHNIC MIX:** Polynesian 92%, other 6%, Kiribati 2%

**GOVERNMENT:** Nonparty system

**CURRENCY:** Australian dollar and Tuvaluan dollar = 100 cents each